



READ-ONLY MIGRATION AUDIT

SEO links, metadata and **robots.txt** comparison

Old WordPress / WooCommerce backup versus the current React + Laravel project

AUDIT DATE

21 July 2026

LEGACY SOURCE

GoDaddy backup · 30-06-2026

CHANGE POLICY

Analysis only · no application or database changes

EXECUTIVE VERDICT

The catalogue migration is strong; the technical SEO handoff is not launch-ready yet.

Product identities and custom metadata were preserved unusually well. The risk is now concentrated in URL redirects, category/page metadata, canonical tags, sitemap delivery, SPA rendering, and which robots file is actually served.

Strong preservation

All 741 imported product slugs match their stored WordPress source URLs. The 709 published WordPress products correspond to 709 active current products. The active product metadata counts also match exactly: 462 custom titles and 520 custom descriptions.

Critical launch gap

The current project has no legacy 301 redirect system, no XML sitemap, no canonical tags, and no single effective robots source. Old category, brand, shop and many page URLs therefore have no search-safe migration path.

CONTENT MIGRATION

Strong

Products, slugs and explicit Rank Math metadata preserved.

URL CONTINUITY

Critical

Product URLs mostly align; category, brand and page redirects are missing.

TECHNICAL SEO

Critical

No canonical, sitemap, SSR metadata, structured data or real 404 response.

SCOPE AND METHOD

What was inspected

- Legacy files under D:\backupfor Godaddy\30-06-2026\public_html.
- Legacy SQL dump mwp_db\i8055463_wp1.sql, streamed read-only without importing it.
- Current React routes and metadata components, Laravel controllers/routes/migrations, built frontend output, and current local SEO database values.
- Legacy Rank Math settings, robots rules, cached sitemap files, redirect table and 404 log.

Limitations: this is a backup/code/database comparison, not a live production crawl or Google Search Console audit. Cached legacy sitemaps can be stale. No credentials, tokens, customer records or other private SQL content are reproduced.

Legacy versus current coverage

PUBLISHED PRODUCTS

709

Old WordPress and current active count both equal 709.

LEGACY PRODUCT CATEGORIES

95

Mapped into 13 current categories and 82 subcategories.

LEGACY PUBLISHED PAGES

35

Current fixed-page SEO manager contains only 10 records.

LEGACY REDIRECTS

69

65 active 301 rules; current project has no redirect table.

ACTIVE REDIRECT HITS

15,289

Evidence that legacy redirect paths still carry real demand.

CURRENT SITEMAP URLS

0

No sitemap route or generated XML exists.

Area	WordPress backup	Current project	Assessment
Product records	709 published; 8 draft; 24 private; 4 trash	709 active; 32 inactive; trashed records excluded	Aligned
Product slugs	/product/{slug}/	741/741 imported slugs preserved	Strong
Product catalogue visibility	709 published	667 currently eligible through public API filters	Review 42
Taxonomy	95 product_cat terms	13 categories + 82 subcategories	Count preserved
Page SEO	35 published pages; 8 with custom title + description	10 fixed records; 10 titles; 0 descriptions	Incomplete
Brand archives	/brand/{slug}/	52 brands imported, but no public brand detail route	Missing URLs

Legacy links and current destinations

Legacy WordPress pattern	Current pattern / replacement	Status	Required handling
/product/{slug}/	/product/{slug} and a second nested product route	Mostly preserved	Choose the short route as canonical; 301 trailing-slash and nested duplicates to it.
/product-category/{slug}/	/categories/{top-slug} or /categories/{top}/sub-categories/{slug}	No legacy route	Generate 95 exact 301 mappings from stored source_url.
/brand/{slug}/	No public brand detail route	Missing	Create indexable brand pages or redirect each brand to a relevant filtered catalogue.
/shop/	/search	No redirect	Use an indexable catalogue route; do not redirect the main shop to a noindex query result.
/wishlist/	/favourites	Replacement exists	301 if public; retain noindex on the account utility page.
/my-account/	/profile / /login	Replacement exists	Redirect based on chosen account entry point; keep noindex.
/contact-us/, /about-us/, /faqs/, policies and campaign pages	Most have no equivalent current route	Content gap	Recreate valuable pages or redirect one-to-one to the closest relevant destination.
Unknown legacy paths	React catch-all redirects client-side to home	Soft 404	Return genuine HTTP 404/410 or an explicit server-side 301.

Duplicate current product URLs

The same product is linked internally through both /product/{slug} and /categories/{category}/sub-categories/{subcategory}/products/{slug}. No canonical tag exists. Search engines can treat these as duplicate pages and split ranking signals.

Recommended canonical

Use https://www.messaraliving.com/product/{slug}. It is closest to the legacy WooCommerce product URL, uses the already-preserved slug, and remains stable when taxonomy changes.

Highest-use legacy redirects

Source	Legacy target	Hits	Migration note
/outdoor-category/	/outdoor-furniture-category/	9,359	Retarget to current outdoor category.
/product/10765/	Named product URL	1,127	Retarget directly to preserved current product slug.
/flooring-cat/	/flooring/	839	Retarget to current flooring category.
/about-us-3/	/about-us/	295	Requires a current About page or nearest valid destination.
/product/19756/	Named product URL	162	Retarget to current product.
/ramandan-offer/	/special-collection/	162	Retarget to an active offer/category page.

There are 69 total Rank Math 301 rules: 65 active and 4 inactive. Thirty-one active rules point to search or filtered-shop URLs that the old configuration itself disallowed or marked noindex. Preserve the source paths, but retarget them to indexable product/category destinations rather than copying those targets unchanged.

What migrated and what remains disconnected

SEO element	Legacy WordPress	Current project	Result
Product custom titles	462 / 709 published	462 / 709 active	Exact migration
Product custom descriptions	520 / 709 published	520 / 709 active	Exact migration
Product focus keywords	636 / 709	No equivalent field	Optional loss
Explicit product canonicals	0 overrides; Rank Math generated defaults	No canonical implementation	Missing output
Product title/description delivery	Server-rendered by WordPress	Injected after React/API execution	Crawler/social risk
Category custom metadata	23 / 95 terms had title + description	13 category fields all empty; 82 subcategories have no SEO columns	Not migrated
Page custom metadata	8 / 35 pages	10 fixed titles; all 10 descriptions empty	Not migrated
Open Graph / Twitter cards	Rank Math supplied social metadata	No implementation detected	Missing
Structured data	Rank Math/WooCommerce generated product schema	No JSON-LD detected	Missing

Current metadata quality issues

- 247 active products lack a custom SEO title; 189 lack a custom description.
- 390 active product titles exceed 60 characters; 257 descriptions exceed 160 characters.
- Five duplicate-title groups and six duplicate-description groups are present.
- 89 active titles and 255 descriptions contain literal `&`, which should be decoded before output.
- Dynamic category/subcategory requests have no wired metadata response. Failed SEO requests can leave the previous route's title, description or robots directive in the DOM.
- A product opened after a noindex utility page can inherit `noindex`, because product pages set title/description but do not reset robots.

Image alt coverage

Image group	Populated	Total	Coverage
Legacy WordPress attachments	4,483	7,001	64.0%
Current product gallery	2,759	3,605	76.5%
Current colours	775	784	98.9%
Current categories / subcategories / brands / banners	0	162 combined	0%

The old robots file was virtual; the current project has three conflicting realities.

WordPress had no root physical `robots.txt`. Rank Math stored 1,550 characters of rules in the database and WordPress generated `/robots.txt` dynamically. The current project stores editable text in `seo_settings`, but a physical Laravel `public/robots.txt` shadows that route under Apache, while the React origin has no robots file and returns the app HTML.

Area	Legacy Rank Math	Current state	Assessment
Wildcard crawling	User-agent: * with targeted blocks	DB: allow all + block dashboard. Static API file: blank disallow (allow all).	Conflict
Admin/API	Blocked <code>/wp-admin/</code> ; allowed admin AJAX	DB intends <code>/dashboard</code> ; actually served API file does not block it	Not effective
Private commerce pages	Blocked cart, checkout and my-account	Cart/profile/favourites have noindex records, but robots handling is inconsistent	Needs one policy
Search and filters	Blocked search plus price, rating, stock, sort, brand, filter and pagination parameters	<code>/search</code> is marked indexable; query variants have no canonical/noindex distinction	Index bloat risk
Feeds	Blocked feed paths	No feed feature detected	Legacy rule unnecessary
AdsBot / Bing / Yandex	AdsBot allowed; Bing/Yandex crawl delay 5	No special groups	Reassess, do not copy blindly
Sitemap directive	Sitemap: <code>https://www.messaraliving.com/sitemap_index.xml</code>	No sitemap directive and no sitemap exists	Critical

Important robots principle

A robots disallow rule is not a security control and does not guarantee deindexing. Public utility/search routes should also emit reliable `noindex` metadata or HTTP headers. Search engines must sometimes be allowed to crawl a URL in order to see its `noindex` directive.

Candidate Laravel/React-era policy

This is a design starting point, not a file that was applied. Confirm the production origin, API path and sitemap URL before implementation.

```
User-agent: *
Allow: /
Disallow: /dashboard/
Disallow: /api/
Disallow: /cart/
Disallow: /profile/
Disallow: /favourites/
Disallow: /search

Sitemap: https://www.messaraliving.com/sitemap.xml
```

Keep login, registration, reset-password and other utility pages explicitly **noindex**. Do not copy WordPress-only paths such as `/wp-admin/`, `/wp-content/uploads/wc-logs/` or feed rules unless those resources still exist.

Legacy sitemap coverage existed; the current application has none.

Capability	Legacy WordPress	Current React/Laravel
Sitemap index	Rank Math virtual /sitemap_index.xml	No route or XML file
Pages	35 cached page URLs	No sitemap entries
Products	Four cached product sitemaps; 711 loc entries, 695 unique due to 16 duplicates	No sitemap entries
Categories/brands	Configured indexable but excluded/off in sitemap settings	No sitemap entries and incomplete public SEO pages
Images	Rank Math image sitemap support enabled	No image sitemap

The new sitemap should include only canonical, indexable, HTTP-200 pages: the home/static pages selected for search, active categories/subcategories with real landing content, and the 667 products currently eligible through the public API. It must exclude dashboard/auth/account/cart/search/filter variants, inactive catalogue records and duplicate nested product URLs.

SPA rendering risk

The built React HTML contains only a generic title and no description/robots metadata. Metadata is added after JavaScript and API execution. Google can often render JavaScript, but social preview crawlers and many other bots do not. Unknown paths also return the SPA document with HTTP 200 before client-side handling, creating soft 404s.

Recommended delivery model

Use SSR or controlled prerendering for every indexable route, or serve crawler-ready HTML from the backend. Each response should contain title, description, canonical, robots, Open Graph/Twitter fields and JSON-LD before JavaScript runs.

Recommended order before domain cutover

1

Choose one product URL

Canonicalize on `/product/{slug}`. Replace nested internal links and issue server-side 301s from duplicate/trailing-slash variants.

2

Build the legacy redirect map

Use stored `source_url` for all products, 13 categories, 82 subcategories and 52 brands; then add the 65 active Rank Math rules. Retarget the 31 rules currently leading to search/filtered noindex pages.

3

Make robots.txt single-source and effective

Serve one robots response from the public production origin. Remove the static-vs-database conflict and ensure admin edits update what crawlers actually receive.

4

Generate a clean XML sitemap

Include only canonical, active, indexable 200 URLs. Add the final sitemap URL to robots.txt and submit it in Search Console.

5

Restore category and page metadata

Import the 23 legacy product-category title/description pairs, support subcategory SEO fields, restore the eight valuable legacy page metadata sets, and add content/redirect decisions for all 35 old pages.

6

Serve metadata in initial HTML

Add SSR/prerendering plus canonical, robots reset, Open Graph, Twitter cards, Product/Offer, Breadcrumb, Organization and FAQ schema.

7

Return real HTTP status codes

Use 404/410 for missing content and 301 only for known replacements. Avoid redirecting unknown URLs to home.

8

Clean and monitor

Decode HTML entities, shorten overlong metadata, resolve duplicates, complete image alt text, crawl staging, validate schema, and monitor Search Console after launch.

Suggested acceptance checks

1. `curl -I` every legacy URL group and verify exactly one 301 hop to a canonical 200 page.
2. Verify `/robots.txt` on the public domain returns `text/plain`, the approved rules, and a valid sitemap directive.
3. Verify `/sitemap.xml` returns valid XML containing no inactive, noindex, redirect, duplicate or 404 URLs.

4. View page source—not only DevTools—and confirm metadata/schema exists before JavaScript.
5. Confirm unknown product/category paths return HTTP 404 and removed content returns 404/410.
6. Run a full staging crawl and compare title, description, canonical, robots, status and internal links against the migration map.

Primary evidence locations

Legacy WordPress backup

- `public_html\.htaccess` — HTTPS and www canonical host redirects plus WordPress rewriting.
- `mwp_db\i8055463_wp1.sql` — site/home URL, permalink bases, active Rank Math plugin, robots content, metadata, taxonomy, redirects and 404 logs.
- Key SQL areas: options around lines 73,575–74,061; Rank Math product metadata around line 246,538 onward; posts around line 301,990; Rank Math redirects around line 315,844.
- `public_html\wp-content\uploads\rank-math\` — cached sitemap index/page/product XML evidence.

Current React/Laravel project

- `ecommerce-react\src\App.jsx` — public and duplicate route patterns.
- `ecommerce-react\src\components\PageSeo.jsx` and `pages\PublicProductDetailPage.jsx` — client-side metadata behavior.
- `ecommerce-api\app\Http\Controllers\Api\SeoController.php` — editable fixed-page SEO and database-backed robots response.
- `ecommerce-api\public\robots.txt` and `routes\web.php` — static-file conflict with the Laravel robots route.
- `ecommerce-api\database\migrations\2026_07_16_000000_add_seo_management.php` — ten fixed SEO pages and robots setting.
- `ecommerce-api\app\Console\Commands\ImportWordPressCatalog.php` — retained WordPress IDs/source URLs and imported catalogue metadata.

Prepared as a read-only audit. No React, Laravel, WordPress backup, robots file, database row, redirect or SEO setting was modified. The only generated deliverable is this audit report.